

# (In) Security in graph databases

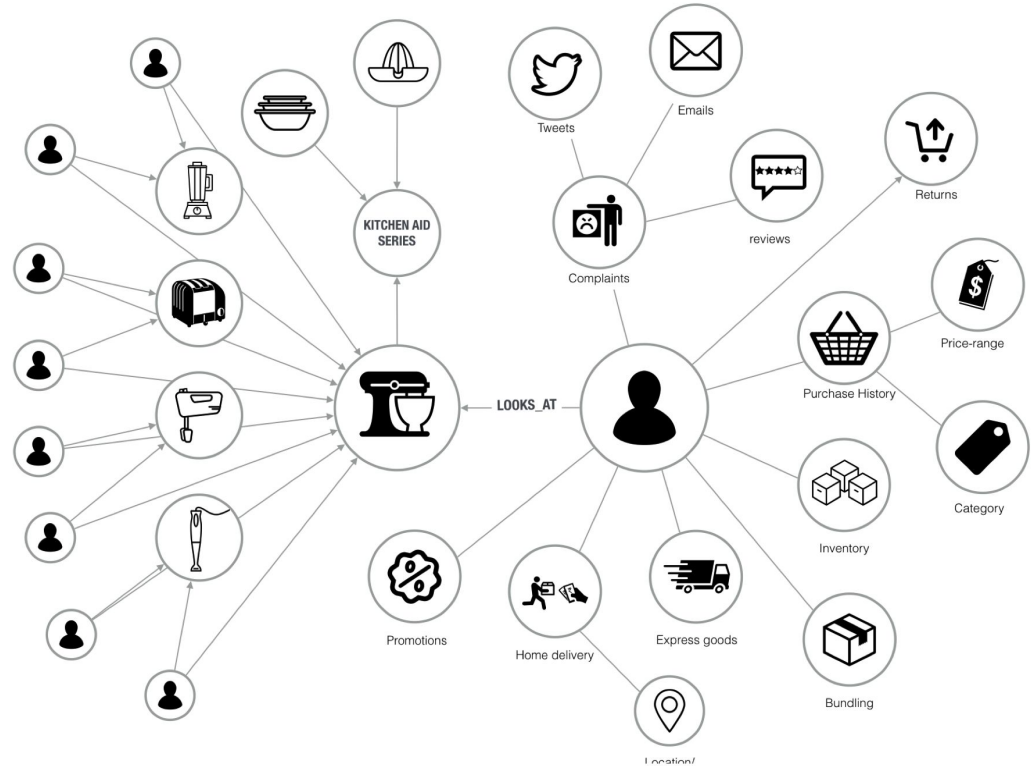
## Analysis and data leaks



**Dr. Alfonso Muñoz - @mindcrypt**  
Senior Cybersecurity Expert & Research Lead

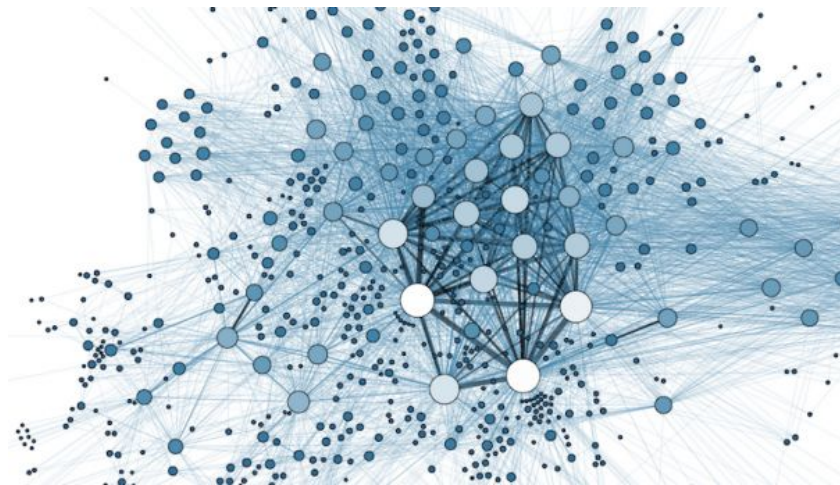


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# Agenda

- Why this research? Why Graph databases?
- Summary of findings (Neo4j & Orientdb)
- Attacks in Neo4j & OrientDB
- Internet exposure
- Conclusions



# Why this research? Why Graph Databases? Analytics?

## Why Facebook and the NSA love graph databases

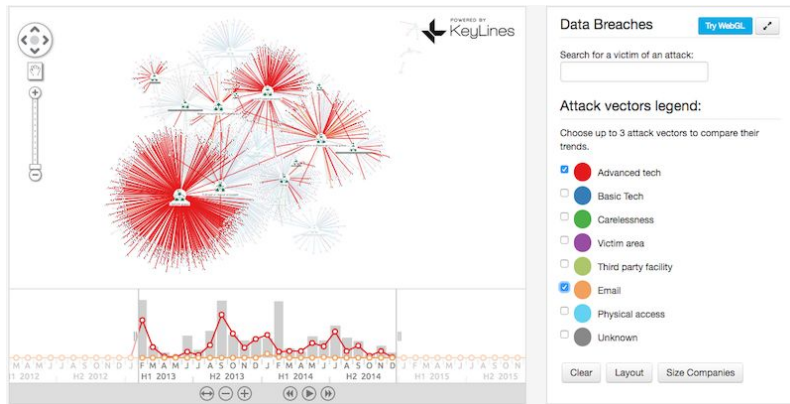
searchdatacenter.techtarget.com/feature/Why-Facebook-and-the-NSA-love-graph-databases

ars TECHNICA UK

### GCHQ open-sources surveillance graph database software on GitHub

Released under Apache licence, Gaffer may look for the "boss" of a network.

ANDRII DEGELER - DEC 15, 2015 11:05 AM UTC



23 systems in ranking, February 2017

| Rank     |          |          | DBMS           | Database Model | Score    |          |          |
|----------|----------|----------|----------------|----------------|----------|----------|----------|
| Feb 2017 | Jan 2017 | Feb 2016 |                |                | Feb 2017 | Jan 2017 | Feb 2016 |
| 1.       | 1.       | 1.       | Neo4j +        | Graph DBMS     | 36.27    | +0.00    | +3.98    |
| 2.       | 2.       | 2.       | OrientDB +     | Multi-model i  | 5.87     | +0.06    | -0.55    |
| 3.       | 3.       | 3.       | Titan          | Graph DBMS     | 5.08     | -0.42    | -0.27    |
| 4.       | 4.       | 5.       | ArangoDB       | Multi-model i  | 2.48     | +0.07    | +1.04    |
| 5.       | 5.       | 4.       | Virtuoso       | Multi-model i  | 2.14     | -0.23    | -0.85    |
| 6.       | 6.       | 6.       | Giraph         | Graph DBMS     | 1.03     | -0.01    | +0.05    |
| 7.       | 8.       | 7.       | AllegroGraph + | Multi-model i  | 0.48     | +0.02    | -0.18    |
| 8.       | 7.       | 8.       | Stardog        | Multi-model i  | 0.46     | -0.07    | -0.08    |
| 9.       | 9.       | 17.      | GraphDB        | Multi-model i  | 0.35     | +0.05    | +0.26    |
| 10.      | 10.      | 9.       | Sqrrl          | Multi-model i  | 0.29     | +0.03    | -0.05    |
| 11.      | 11.      | 10.      | InfiniteGraph  | Graph DBMS     | 0.22     | +0.04    | -0.09    |
| 12.      | 13.      |          | Dgraph         | Graph DBMS     | 0.19     | +0.06    |          |
| 13.      | 15.      | 18.      | Blazegraph +   | Multi-model i  | 0.14     | +0.06    | +0.07    |
| 14.      | 14.      | 14.      | FlockDB        | Graph DBMS     | 0.12     | +0.02    | -0.02    |
| 15.      | 12.      | 15.      | InfoGrid       | Graph DBMS     | 0.11     | -0.05    | -0.03    |
| 16.      | 17.      | 13.      | HyperGraphDB   | Graph DBMS     | 0.09     | +0.03    | -0.08    |
| 17.      | 16.      | 12.      | GlobalsDB      | Multi-model i  | 0.06     | +0.00    | -0.12    |
| 18.      | 18.      | 19.      | GraphBase      | Graph DBMS     | 0.03     | -0.00    | -0.01    |
| 19.      | 19.      | 11.      | Sparksee       | Graph DBMS     | 0.02     | -0.01    | -0.18    |
| 20.      | 21.      |          | AgensGraph     | Multi-model i  | 0.00     | ±0.00    |          |
| 20.      | 21.      | 20.      | Amisa Server   | Multi-model i  | 0.00     | ±0.00    | ±0.00    |
| 20.      |          |          | GRAKN.AI +     | Graph DBMS     | 0.00     |          |          |
| 20.      | 20.      | 16.      | VelocityGraph  | Graph DBMS     | 0.00     | -0.00    | -0.12    |

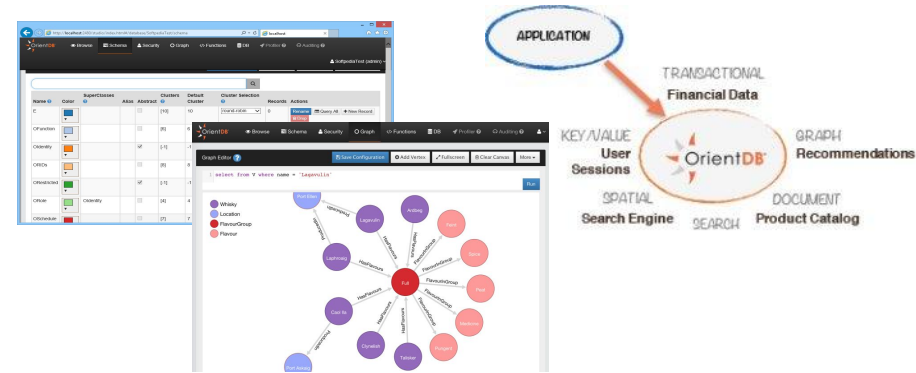
By 2020, sophisticated criminals will be able to beat 90% of the organizations who have deployed advanced analytic systems.

The Fast Evolving State of

Adversarial Machine Learning & Security Analytics 2016-2017

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## OrientDB - The World's First Distributed Multi-Model NoSQL Database with a Graph Database Engine

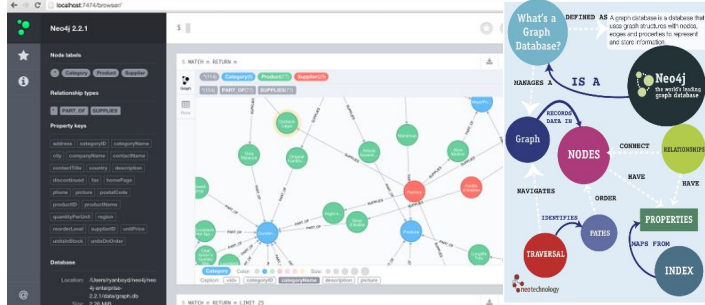
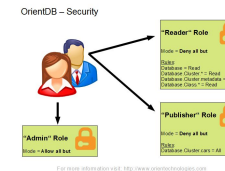


### Operations

Looking for incremental Backups? We've got that covered. What's more, with OrientDB's latest 2.2 version, the new **OrientDB Studio** adds a new peer-to-peer architecture and new modules. We've also officially released **Teleporter**: a new tool to sync with relational databases and simplify migrations to OrientDB. OrientDB 2.2 also introduces the **Neo4j to OrientDB importer**, allowing you to import your Neo4j graph to OrientDB in a few simple steps.



Manage virtually every aspect of your database through OrientDB Studio.

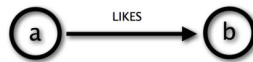


**Neo4j** is a **graph database** management system developed by Neo Technology, Inc. in java. Described by its developers as an ACID-compliant transactional database with native graph storage and processing.

In **Neo4j**, everything is stored in the form of either an edge, a node, or an attribute.

## Cypher (Graph Query Language)

Cypher using relationship 'likes'

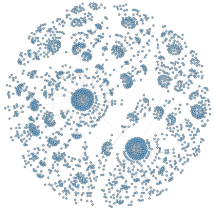


Cypher

(a) -[:LIKES]-> (b)

# Summary of findings (Neo4j & Orientdb)

- Design Errors
  - Best password hashing option (**Neo4j**).
  - Possibility to access root account directly (**OrientDB**).
  - Possibility to replace root credentials without response of server (**Neo4j**).
  - Security measures based on licenses (pay for more security) (**Neo4j**).
- Configuration Errors
  - Exposed database to Internet by default (**OrientDB**).
  - Create default users and databases (**OrientDB**).
- Security Errors
  - User management is not provided (**Neo4j < 3.1 version**).
  - Send OPTION requests with a database with authentication (**Neo4j**).
  - Vulnerable versions are currently used (**Neo4j & OrientDB**).
  - HTTP protocol (**Neo4j & OrientDB**).



# Security considerations in Neo4j

- Vulnerability for < 1.9.x: CVE-2013-7259 execute arbitrary code (DefCon 21)
- User Management
  - Only one user: neo4j in all versions < 3.1
  - User/password by default: neo4j/neo4j
  - Improper password management
    - Bad password policy (from 1 character and no without characters restriction)
    - Better options for password store (now sha256+salt).
    - Insuffer anti-automatitaton password attacks (delay 5 seconds each 3 password tries)
      - It is possible password brute-force attack from different IPs (Proxies...)
      - Attack without response (change password) - <http://ip:7474/user/neo4j/password>
- Database fingerprinting: Neo4j is 3.x or lower (fixed paths)
- Community & Enterprise license: Logs (query and security logs) only in Enterprise Edition.
- ¿Database exposure?
  - Authentication enabled by default: `dbms.security.auth_enabled=true`
  - Not exposed to Internet by default: `server.webserver.address=0.0.0.0`
- Send “anonymous” queries to other sites...



# Notes: Attacks from Neo4j “without credentials”

The screenshot displays the Neo4j Browser interface. The top navigation bar includes 'File', 'Edit', 'View', 'History', 'Bookmarks', 'Tools', and 'Help'. The address bar shows 'localhost:7474/browser/'. Below the address bar, a list of 'Most Visited' sites is visible, including 'Offensive Security', 'Kali Linux', 'Kali Docs', 'Kali Tools', 'Exploit-DB', and 'Aircrack-ng'.

The main content area shows a command prompt with the input `$ :GET http://www.elmundo.es`. Below this, a blue error banner states: 'Database access not available. Please use `:server connect` to establish connection. There's a graph waiting for you.'

The command history shows the same input: `:GET http://www.elmundo.es`. Below the history, the error message 'Error: 0 -' is displayed, followed by a red warning icon and the text 'Request error'.

A yellow callout box highlights the command `:GET, :PUT, :POST` and the text 'Query to the URL server (Why?) OPTIONS / HTTP/1.1'.

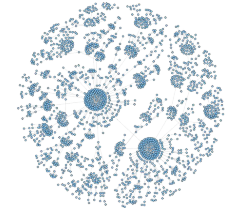
At the bottom left, a 'Connect to Neo4j' dialog box is shown, indicating that 'Database access requires an authenticated connection.' The 'Username' field is filled with 'neo4j', and the 'Password' field is empty.

At the bottom right, a 'help commands' dialog box is open, displaying a list of client-side commands that begin with a colon. The commands are categorized as follows:

- Information: `:help help`, `:help play`
- Server connection: `:help server`
- User administration: `:help server user`
- REST: `:help REST GET`, `:help REST POST`, `:help REST PUT`, `:help REST DELETE`
- Database: `:help schema`
- Editor: `:help clear`
- Command history: `:help history`
- Params: `:help param`, `:help params`
- Query status: `:help queries`

The 'Connect to Neo4j' dialog box at the bottom right also shows the 'Username' field filled with 'neo4j' and the 'Password' field empty.

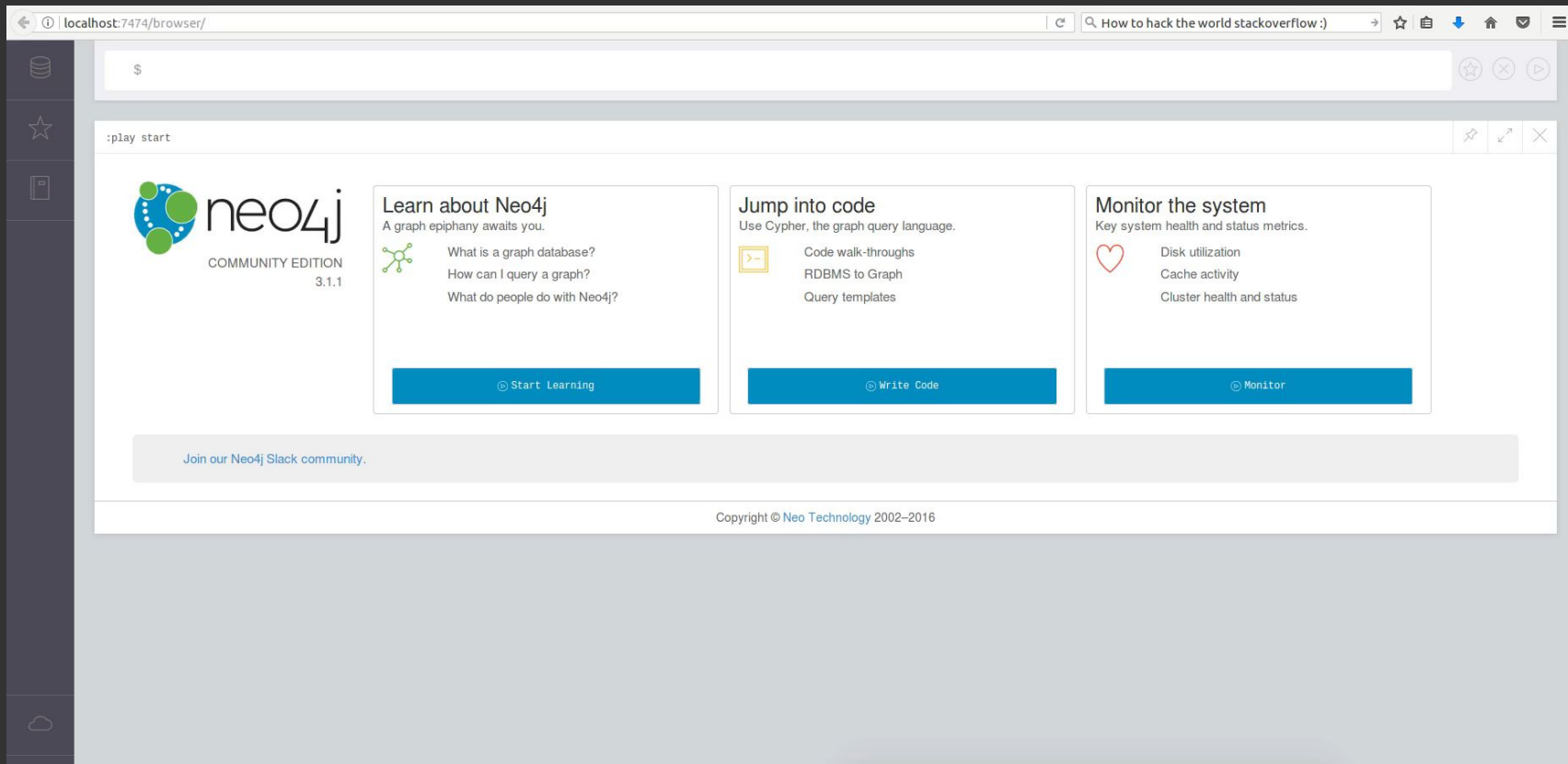
# Notes: Attacks in Neo4j “with credentials”



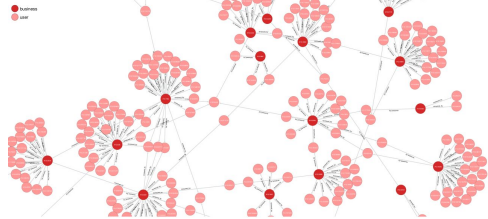
- **If an attacker has the password for the Neo4j user (database empty, password by default, password guessing or software/apps with improper parameter validation connecting with Neo4j db)**
- Database “DUMP”
  - `MATCH (N)-[R]-(M) RETURN N,R,M`
- Database “DROP”, INSERT o MODIFY (C&C, ilegal material, cover channels, ...)
  - `MATCH (N)-[R]-(M) DELETE N,R,M (LIMIT 10000)`
- RAM DoS
  - `FOREACH (x in range(1,1000000000000000) | CREATE (:Person {name:"name"+x, age: x%100}));`
- Disk DoS
  - `USING PERIODIC COMMIT 1000 LOAD CSV FROM {url} CREATE (a:person{name:row[0]});`
- **New way of Ransomware**
  - 1. – Compute “functions” on the Graph Databases (replace + homophonic Cipher)
  - 2. – Where are the links among nodes?
  - 3. – if combine 1+2+...



# Ransomware attacks – Neo4j



# Security considerations in OrientDB



- Variety of versions: We analyze the last versions 2.2.x, in 2016/2017
- Two licenses, community and enterprise (the same security approach)
- Starting the server (1 OrientDB server -> N databases)
  - OrientDB server have always the root user / remote connection.
  - OrientDB stores password using PBKDF2 algorithm
  - 3 default users per each database (`admin/admin`, `writer/writer`, `reader/reader`)
  - A specific database is “created”, the name is GratefulDeadConcerts.
- Bad documentation (User’s Manual) – Mistakes about security
  - OrientDB exposed to Internet by default, and “that is NOT recommended in the documentation”
- Security problems
  - You can list ALL databases without authentication (`http://<ip>:2480/listDatabases` )
  - Fingerprinting of the version database (`http://<ip>:2480/listDatabases` )
  - Default credentials in each database.
  - No countermeasures against brute-force login attacks.
  - Brute-force attacks to root account (remote)
  - Fast download database: `http://ip:2480/database/export`



## GraFSCaN Help:

```
-----
|                               |
|           GraFSCaN           |
|                               |
| Authors: Miguel Hernández (@MiguelHzBz)|
|         Alfonso Muñoz (@mindcrypt)   |
| Version: v1.0                   |
|                               |
| Last update: April 28, 2017      |
|                               |
|-----|
```

A pentesting tool for graph databases

```
usage: GraFScan.py [-h] [-neo4j] [-orient] [-arango] [-virtuoso] [-allegro]
                  [-all] [-ip IP] [-n NET] [-i FILEINPUT] [-o OUTPUT] [-B]
                  [-dict DICT] [-proxies PROXIES] [-nl] [-tor] [-DoS]
```

GraFSCaN analyses the input to search Neo4j, OrientDB, ArangoDB, AllegroGraph and VirtuosoDB graph database.

### optional arguments:

|                       |                                                                                      |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| -h, --help            | show this help message and exit                                                      |
| -neo4j                | Discover and analyze Neo4j Graph database                                            |
| -orient               | Discover and analyze Orient Graph Database                                           |
| -arango               | Discover and analyze Arango Graph Database                                           |
| -virtuoso             | Discover and analyze virtuoso Graph Database                                         |
| -allegro              | Discover and analyze allegro Graph Database                                          |
| -all                  | Discover and analyze All Graph Database                                              |
| -ip IP                | Input one ip to analyse.                                                             |
| -n NET, --network NET | Input one network to analyse.                                                        |
| -i FILEINPUT          | Input one file with one ip each line to analyse.                                     |
| -o OUTPUT             | Output file                                                                          |
| -B, --bruteforce      | Option to use brute force with authentication Neo4j.                                 |
| -dict DICT            | Dictionary file, one password per line                                               |
| -proxies PROXIES      | Proxies file, format: <ip><port>                                                     |
| -nl, --no-limit       | Option to dump all database of Neo4j without auth.                                   |
| -tor                  | Option to use proxy TOR to scan de input data, need install and run before executed. |
| -DoS                  | Option to use DoS without authentication Neo4j.                                      |

## Output:

### Neo4j with auth:

- ip: Ip analyzed.
- authentication: True.
- version: < 3.X or > 3.X.
- change\_password: boolean if the bruteforce was succesfull or not, and add old\_password if was true. Only if you use brute force option.

### Neo4j without auth:

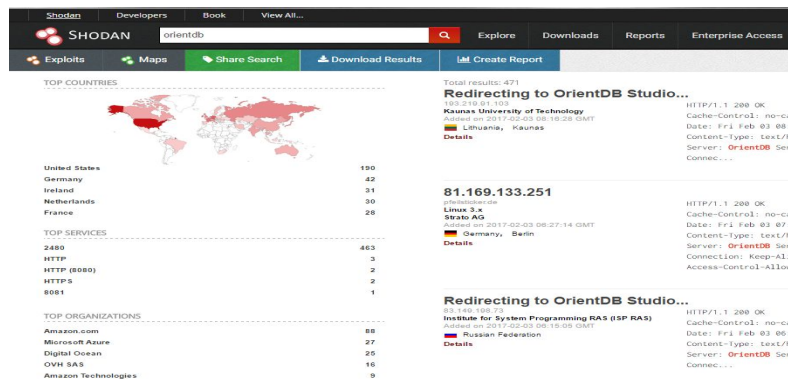
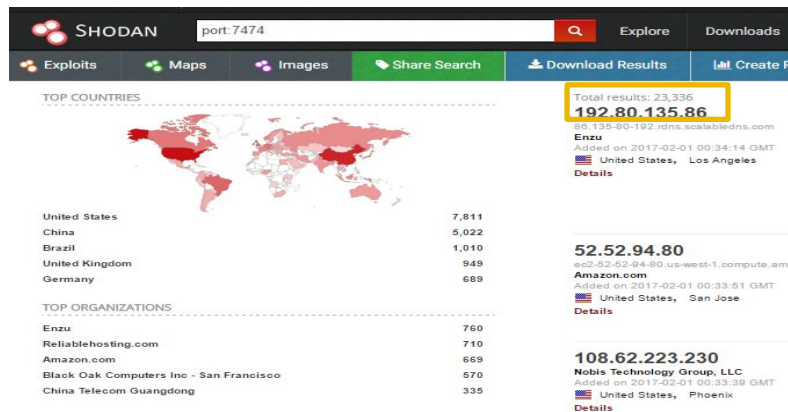
- info: Json with the return of query in cypher Match (n)-[r]-(m) Return n,r,m.
- license: Two values, version and license, community or enterprise.
- NumNodes: Number of index to the nodes.
- ip: Ip analyzed.
- NumProperties: Number of index to the properties.
- NumRelationships: Number of index to the edges.
- labels: Array with all labels of nodes in the graph database.
- props: Array with all the key of all properties in the graph database.
- types: Array with all labels of edges in the graph database.
- cluster: Boolean to know if this instance is part of cluster, if the value is true, appear if this instance was slave or master.
- version: Version of Neo4j instance.

### OrientDB:

- databases: Array with all names of databases in OrientDB Server.
- version\_OrientDB: Version of OrientDB Server.
- server\_pass: Password of root user.
- server\_info: Json object with all information of server: connections, globalproperties, storages and properties. Only if you use brute force option.

The tool tries to export all databases in the OrientDB Server, it creates a folder with the IP as name and put into the compress databases. Only use default auth to send the request.

# Internet and Neo4j/OrientDB Shodan, Zmap, Masscan...



## Neo4j Databases

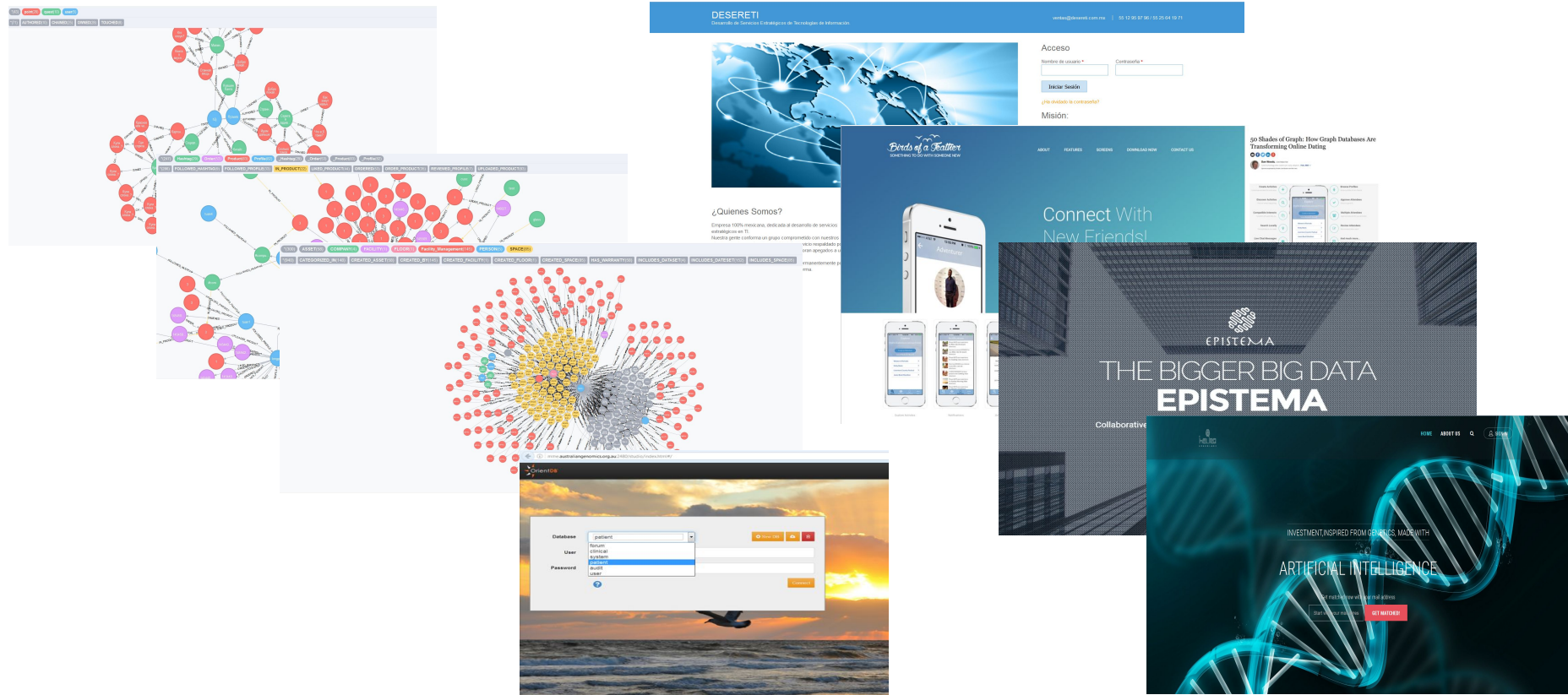
|                           |       |     |     |     |
|---------------------------|-------|-----|-----|-----|
| Potential Neo4j Databases | 33772 |     |     |     |
| Databases                 | ~1300 |     |     |     |
| With authentication       | ~1000 |     |     |     |
| Empty Databases           | 28    |     |     |     |
| Without authentication    | 1.9   | 2.X | 3.0 | 3.1 |
|                           | 17    | 251 | 30  | 0   |

## OrientDB Databases

|                            |      |     |     |     |
|----------------------------|------|-----|-----|-----|
| Potential OrientDB Servers | 3792 |     |     |     |
| Servers                    | 214  |     |     |     |
| Databases                  | 553  |     |     |     |
| Versions                   | 1.x  | 2.0 | 2.1 | 2.2 |
|                            | 16   | 30  | 64  | 104 |

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# Examples



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# Conclusion – Security Graph Databases

- What do you think? - (In) Security Graph Databases
- 1<sup>st</sup> Graph Databases hacking tool (PoC): <https://github.com/grafscan/GraFSCaN>
- +600 exposed graph databases: public organisms, companies, “security controls”, ...
- Security design issues: default configuration, brute-force login attacks, “password policies”, password storage, “queries to third-parties”, DoS and Ransomware attacks...
- Basics: Configuration?, Configuration?, ....

<https://neo4j.com/docs/operations-manual/current/security/checklist>

[/orientdb-community-2.2.15/config/security.json](#)

[/orientdb-community-2.2.15/config/orientdb-server-config.xml](#)

## Why Cybersecurity Should Be The Biggest Concern Of 2017

POST WRITTEN BY

**Cesar Cerrudo**

Cesar Cerrudo is a professional hacker and the CTO of [IOActive Labs](#), where he works on cutting-edge cybersecurity research.



I've been a professional hacker for more than 15 years. I find cybersecurity problems in technology in order to make that technology more secure. But after doing this for many years, I'm frustrated. I see the same problems over and over again. We are not getting better. And while we depend more and more on technology, technology is becoming more and more insecure.



# Questions & doubts?

## (In) Security in graph databases – Analysis and data leaks



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# Thanks!!!